Dublin’s budget pitch riles Brussels

送信者: POLITICO Brussels Playbook 受信日時: 2026-10-12 13:43

【メール原文】

Presented by EFPIA By NICHOLAS VINOCUR with GREGORIO SORGI GREETINGS from Warsaw! It’s Nick Vinocur, steeling myself for what promises to be a long, s

Presented by EFPIA

By NICHOLAS VINOCUR

with GREGORIO SORGI

PRESENTED BY

Send tips here | Follow us @gerardofortuna @NicholasVinocur @GabrielGavin | Listen to Playbook and view in your browser

GREETINGS from Warsaw! It’s Nick Vinocur, steeling myself for what promises to be a long, sweaty European Council later this week. Let’s dive in:

In today’s Playbook:

— EU foreign ministers are ready to sign off on the bloc’s biggest Russia sanctions package since the full-scale invasion of Ukraine.

— Brussels’ Zaventem airport needs to get its act together before the Christmas holidays, the EU’s migration commissioner tells Playbook.

— Faces in the crowd: Thomas Byrne, Raphaël Glucksmann, António Costa, Donald Trump, Vladimir Putin, Kaja Kallas, Micheál Martin, Łukasz Gibała, Donald Tusk, Magnus Brunner and more …

On today’s Brussels Playbook Podcast: Zoya and Nick unpack why everyone says they hate the new budget proposal — and why Germany hates it the most.

POLITICAL ADVERTISEMENT

A message from EFPIA:Europe has a pharmaceutical industry worth fighting for. It supports around 2.3 million jobs, invests €60 billion in European R&D every year and generates more than €366 billion in exports. Losing pharmaceutical investment means losing high-value jobs, research, manufacturing and economic activity to other parts of the world.

* Sponsor: European Federation of Pharmaceutical Industries and Associations (EFPIA)
* The political advertisement is linked to European competitiveness

More information about political advertising here .

DRIVING THE DAY

THE NO-GO BOX: The European Commission has come out strongly against Ireland's proposed cuts to the EU's next seven-year budget , days before the bloc's leaders are set to meet in Brussels for a summit on Thursday and Friday.

During a meeting of EU ambassadors on Sunday, the Commission's top budget official Stéphanie Riso warned that cutting over €22 billion from rainy-day funds would make Europe less equipped to deal with future crises, four EU diplomats briefed on the talks, granted anonymity to speak freely, told Gregorio Sorgi.

The Commission is "very concerned about cuts to flexibility," one of the EU diplomats said. As a result of the changes, "we will have no ways left to help farmers and regions when crises hit, because of climate change or geopolitical tensions," they added.

Pushing back: Ireland's Europe Minister Thomas Byrne disputed that claim, saying in a press conference on Saturday that "each heading, under this negotiating box, offers increased flexibility throughout the proposal."

The Irish presidency of the Council of the EU, which is steering the budget talks, cut €159 billion in current prices from the Commission's proposal to appease a German-led group. But that's not enough for Berlin and its allies, who sent an email on Sunday to European Council President António Costa's team to complain about the proposal, according to two EU diplomats.

Frugal view: "We will definitely have to cut cohesion and agriculture" in the next draft of the budget, as it "doesn't make sense to cut in all the priority topics the EUCO is discussing this week," an EU diplomat from one of the so-called frugal states told Playbook.

Ireland focused cuts on competitiveness, foreign aid and emergency funds, while leaving untouched traditional policies such as farmers' subsidies and regional payouts, known as cohesion policy.

That was in response to 17 countries, known as the Friends of Cohesion, asking the Irish presidency to shield agriculture and cohesion from cuts. Most governments preferred reducing flexibility to preserve politically sensitive payouts to regions and farmers.

The big loser: But these changes are a major setback for the Commission, which tried to "modernize" its own budget by steering billions towards new priorities and creating more flexibility to cope with crises. The EU executive warned that Ireland's proposal will make the next budget more rigid than the current one — and potentially require a midterm review to respond to future crises.

In a further blow for the Commission, Ireland also watered down the link between EU payouts and economic reforms in the next budget — which is unpopular among most governments.

All roads lead to EUCO: These tensions set the scene for a fraught European Council, where leaders will react to the Irish proposal and try to make progress toward securing a deal before the end of the year. "Every day you come close to the French election they will be less willing to pay for cohesion," said the EU diplomat.

BIG AND BREAKING

CLIMATE SPLIT: The Socialists and Democrats, Renew Europe and Greens are determined to fight an EU proposal to relax carbon pricing rules — but that could push pro-business conservative lawmakers to seek a deal with the far right, Ben Makuch reports

WHY THE FAR RIGHT IS WINNING: Germany's far right has emerged from the shadows and pushed into the mainstream in large part by radicalizing the country's youth, according to a deep dive by WELT's Alexander Dinger and Lennart Pfahler. (WELT is owned by Axel Springer, POLITICO's parent company.)

RACE FOR THE ELYSÉE: MEP Raphaël Glucksmann won France's center-left presidential primary on Sunday , formally securing the backing of the Socialist Party and its allies for next year's election with more than 66% of the vote.

TROUBLE DOWN UNDER: Australia's trade minister has warned opposition lawmakers that Brussels won't offer better terms if parliament rejects the EU-Australia free trade deal. "There is no room for negotiation here. The deal is done," Don Farrell said. My colleagues in Canberra have the latest. My colleagues in Canberra have the latest .

POLITICAL ADVERTISEMENT

* Sponsor: European Federation of Pharmaceutical Industries and Associations (EFPIA)
* The political advertisement is linked to European competitiveness

More information about political advertising here .

RUSSIA SANCTIONS

BRUSSELS TURNS THE SCREWS ON MOSCOW: EU ministers will today sign off on the bloc's biggest package of sanctions against Russia since the start of its full-scale invasion of Ukraine, targeting Moscow's ability to produce missiles in a show of force amid escalating hybrid attacks, four EU diplomats and officials said.

That's not all: Foreign ministers gathering in Luxembourg will also push ahead with plans to restrict visas for Russian tourists and ex-combatants, while examining ways to limit the movements of Russian diplomats inside the bloc, per the same officials.

What it's about: The EU is flexing its legal muscles just over a month after Germany formally blamed Russia for a thwarted drone attack in Leipzig. The bloc will target more than 1,600 individuals and "entities" (mainly companies supporting Moscow's war effort).

Hitting the chain: Those sanctions — more than half of which target Russia's ballistic missile production chain — will be locked in for three years, the officials said.

Hey, Moscow! The package is a "clear response from the EU" to hybrid attacks, said a senior EU diplomat, granted anonymity to discuss confidential sanctions. "We certainly hope this will further hamper the ability for Russia to produce missiles."

Trump trouble: Yet any hope that Europe and the U.S. would join forces to sanction Moscow seemed to have been dashed after U.S. President Donald Trump announced on Friday he'd struck a deal with Russia's Vladimir Putin to purchase Russian diesel — and then called on Ukraine to install a new leader .

European politicians rallied behind Volodymyr Zelenskyy over the weekend, with Polish PM Donald Tusk posting on X that the Ukrainian president can count on "Europe's full solidarity." Trump's surprise diesel deal has also sparked a bipartisan backlash in Washington: One group of senators has urged the president to "immediately reverse course," saying the decision was illegal and risks giving Putin a "financial lifeline while Russia continues to kill Ukrainian civilians."

But Trump wasn't done with the surprises, announcing yesterday that Kyiv and Moscow had agreed to an energy ceasefire , "effective immediately" — though it wasn't clear if both sides had, in fact, agreed. Zelenskyy said last night that Kyiv wants to see more details . American officials have been ringing around European capitals to persuade Kyiv to stop striking Russian refineries, and Ukraine could be cut off from weapons supplies and intelligence if it doesn't play ball, the Financial Times reports.

Reasons to be skeptical: Kyiv's former Foreign Minister Dmytro Kuleba earlier told the Axel Springer Global Reporters Network that Russia is gearing up to attack other European countries. "We [Ukrainians] don't have to drag you — Putin will drag you into the war," Kuleba warned. (Axel Springer is POLITICO's parent company.)

ALSO ON THE AGENDA IN LUXEMBOURG: Alongside talks on Ukraine, foreign ministers are due today to green-light a new EU mission to train and advise Lebanon's security forces.

Top EU diplomat Kaja Kallas, who'll preside over the Foreign Affairs Council, will also press countries to stump up more ships to the EU's Aspides maritime policing mission, an issue that's only grown more urgent in the wake of deadly Houthi attacks on a Saudi airport, said a second EU official. (One person was killed and 11 injured in a strike on Riyadh airport yesterday, a day after an attack there killed 13, the BBC reports .)

Ministers will also discuss Trump's decision to impose sanctions against the International Criminal Court in The Hague. EU diplomats have hinted that the Netherlands will seek to use the next six months before the sanctions are enforced to negotiate a solution with Washington.

Bonus: Kallas will also issue a "no tolls, no fees" declaration coordinated by the EU's diplomatic arm and backed by 60 countries calling to protect freedom of navigation around the world.

20-SECOND PLAYBOOK PRIMER

There's a Tripartite Social Summit later this week … but what is that? It's a meeting between the EU institutions (Irish PM Micheál Martin and Commission chief Ursula von der Leyen will be there) and what are described as European social partners (in this case that's the likes of BusinessEurope and the European Trade Union Confederation). These meetings take place twice a year and they discuss economic, employment and social policy issues.

TALK TO PLAYBOOK: On the Brussels Playbook Podcast, Zoya asked whether you'd watch influencers' videos from a European Council summit. WhatsApp us on +32 491 050629 and listen from 7 a.m. to hear if we give you a shout-out.

CHRISTMAS AT THE AIRPORT?

DO BETTER, ZAVENTEM: Brussels Airport was singled out for criticism by Migration Commissioner Magnus Brunner as he said EU countries and airports need to “do their job” so travelers aren’t stuck in airports over the Christmas holidays.

The EU’s Entry/Exit System “has to work,” Brunner told Zoya Sheftalovich. “The member states had enough time to prepare themselves for this system.”

Happy anniversary, now wait: A year ago today, Europe began rolling out the EES, which digitally registers the fingerprints and photos of non-EU visitors. Since it became fully operational in April, travelers have been plagued by long waits at some airports — including at Brussels Airport, where people were stuck for up to five hours last month .

“Some member states are a bit behind,” Brunner acknowledged. “We have some challenges, like Zaventem for instance, in Belgium, but also in other member states. And they have to do their job. They agreed on the new system.” The Commission has offered support from border agency Frontex and funding to countries to help implement the system, Brunner said, insisting he’s “very confident” the issues will be ironed out.

Infrastructure at Brussels Airport “cannot cope” with the number of passengers coming into Zaventem and the Brussels Airport Company must “make significant changes,” said a spokesperson for Belgian Interior Minister Bernard Quintin. The airport can process 500 to 600 non-Schengen travelers an hour, compared with nearly 3,500 who arrive between 6 a.m. and 10 a.m. on busy days, he said.

Brussels Airport didn’t directly respond to the criticism, instead saying in a statement that “all parties involved” were working to fix the delays, including by testing new e-gates and pre-registration kiosks and training more police. “The need for additional infrastructure is also being assessed,” the statement said.

DASHBOARD

The Commission’s budget proposal earmarked almost €218 billion in cohesion funding for the bloc’s poorest regions. According to Eurostat figures, the latest year available, most of those regions would be in the east and south of the bloc.

4 MORE THINGS GETTING US TALKING

LACK OF INFLUENCERS: Journalist associations were up in arms about the EU’s decision to invite social media influencers to the bloc’s gatherings earlier this year — but there won’t be any content creators present at this week’s European Council summit, Mari Eccles reports.

MESSAGE TO PUTIN: France is trying to sharpen its air force’s nuclear arm to be a credible deterrent to Russia, its commander told Laura Kayali in a rare interview.

SETBACK FOR TUSK: Independent Łukasz Gibała nabbed the mayoral runoff in Krakow on Sunday, dealing a fresh blow to PM Donald Tusk’s governing Civic Coalition party.

BANKS VS. BOTS: Bank failures, shoppers losing money and cyber attacks are just some of the things that could go wrong as the use of agentic AI ramps up in finance, Eleanor Myers writes .

BRUSSELS CORNER

WEATHER: Partly sunny. High of 18C.

BIRD WATCHERS UNITE: Fall weather has arrived in Brussels and that means it's time to say goodbye to birds now seeking greener pastures. Brussels has several spots used to count birds as they migrate south, including at the Koekelberg Basilica, Cimetière d'Ixelles or Koeivijverdal in Anderlecht.

Pro tip: Look out for red kites, a bird of prey that enthusiasts meeting in Anderlecht are hopeful of spotting this year, VRT writes .

BRUSSELS CLIMATE MARCH: Around 60,000 people marched through Brussels Sunday, disrupting traffic as they called on Belgian politicians to step up climate action, organizers including the Climate Coalition and other NGOs said. The protesters' demands include taxing fossil fuel companies' windfall profits and phasing out fossil fuel subsidies, as well as a fair transition to cleaner energy that protects poorer households and helps people and businesses to make the move. Le Soir has more .

TOP OF THE PLAYBOOKS

Berlin: Friedrich Merz will face the cameras at 1:30 p.m. to explain what concrete changes his center-right Christian Democratic Union intends to make after last month's election debacles.

Paris: Raphaël Glucksmann wants to move quickly after winning the Socialist presidential nomination — now he just needs to mend internal rifts, fend off a potential bid from François Hollande and pry left-wing voters away from Jean-Luc Mélenchon.

London: Andy Burnham will urge British MPs to have a "calm, clear-eyed look" at a new deal with the European Union as Westminster returns from its party conference recess.

Washington: Both parties are still deeply divided over Hamas' vicious Oct. 7 massacre and Israel's brutal military response in Gaza — and the conflict looks set to be a key litmus test in the 2028 presidential race.

Canberra: Deloitte was paid AU$2.2 million to administer grants to upskill the child care workforce, POLITICO scooped , despite a policy making it clear the work should be done by public officials.

AGENDA

— EU foreign ministers meet for the Foreign Affairs Council in Luxembourg. Doorstep with EU High Representative Kaja Kallas at 8 a.m. Press conference around 4:30 p.m. Watch live .

— Warsaw Security Forum begins in Poland, with speakers including Polish PM Donald Tusk, Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, Norwegian PM Jonas Gahr Støre, EU Defense Commissioner Andrius Kubilius and NATO Supreme Allied Commander Europe Gen. Alexus Grynkewich. Agenda . Watch live .

— Coreper II meets in Luxembourg.

— Environment Council meets in Luxembourg. Press conference with Climate Commissioner Wopke Hoekstra and Ireland's Climate Minister Darragh O'Brien around 5:30 p.m. Watch live .

— European Week of Regions and Cities begins in Brussels. Speakers at the opening session at 2:30 p.m. include European Council President António Costa, European Parliament President Roberta Metsola, Commission Executive Vice President Raffaele Fitto and President of the European Committee of the Regions Kata Tüttő. Watch live . Press conference by Fitto and Tüttő at 11 a.m. Watch live .

— European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen participates in the European People's Party Group Study Days in Taormina, Italy.

— 29th accession conference with Montenegro in Luxembourg.

— Informal meeting of telecommunications ministers begins in Limerick with an official dinner and welcome reception.

— Costa meets Commission Executive Vice President Roxana Mînzatu at 6:30 p.m.

— Kallas meets Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha in Luxembourg.

— The European Parliament's Committee on Employment and Social Affairs has exchanges of views with Commission Executive Vice Presidents Stéphane Séjourné (3 p.m.) and Mînzatu (4:15 p.m.). Watch live .

— Fitto meets European Investment Bank President Nadia Calviño.

BIRTHDAYS

MEP Georg Mayer; former MEPs Anna Bonfrisco, David Lega and Martin Horwood; European Court of Auditors member and former MEP Ivana Maletić; former European Commissioner Neven Mimica; Daniel Azzopardi, Malta's ambassador to Italy and San Marino; Universal Music Group's Robbert Baruch; Professor Jem Bendell; European Commission's Franco Accordino. Spain's National Day.

Playbook is brought to you by POLITICO's EU Politics team: Gerardo Fortuna, Nicholas Vinocur, Gabriel Gavin, Zoya Sheftalovich, Max Griera, Mari Eccles, Hanne Cokelaere and Sebastian Starcevic. And: reporters Milena Wälde and Daria Zakharova, editors Alex Spence and James Panichi, and producers Dean Southwell and Hugh Kapernaros.

POLITICAL ADVERTISEMENT

**A message from EFPIA:Europe's pharmaceutical industry is a major economic and industrial asset. Today, the sector supports around 2.3 million jobs, invests €60 billion every year in European R&D and generates more than €366 billion in exports. Without pharmaceuticals, the EU's trade in goods balance would shift from a €128 billion surplus to a €93 billion deficit.These benefits cannot be taken for granted. When a research project, clinical trial or new manufacturing facility goes elsewhere, Europe loses highly skilled jobs, expertise, economic activity and new treatments for patients. And as research and manufacturing ecosystems grow elsewhere, investment follows.Global competition for life sciences investment is fierce. Europe has the scientific excellence and industrial base to compete. Now it needs the policies to grow investment and its benefits here. **

* Sponsor: European Federation of Pharmaceutical Industries and Associations (EFPIA)
* The political advertisement is linked to European competitiveness

More information about political advertising here .

SUBSCRIBE to the POLITICO newsletter family: Brussels Playbook | London Playbook | London Playbook PM | Playbook Paris | Berlin Playbook | Sunday Crunch | EU Influence | London Influence | D.C. Playbook | D.C. Influence | Canada Playbook | POLITICO Forecast | Canberra Playbook | All our POLITICO Pro policy morning newsletters

_____

This email was sent to shondo@iies.co.jp
Update your preferences | Unsubscribe from this email | Unsubscribe from all emails
POLITICO SRL · Rue de la Loi 62 · Brussels 1040 · Belgium